Early Learners

Safety Practices

Performance Standard

§ 1302.47(a)(4) Achieving program goals

(a) *Establishing program goals*. A program, in collaboration with the governing body and policy council, must establish goals and measurable objectives that include:

(4) Effective health and safety practices to ensure children are safe at all times, per the requirements in §§1302.47, 1302.90(b) and (c), 1302.92(c)(1), and 1302.94 and 1303 subpart F, of this chapter.

§ 1302.47(b)(7)(iii) Safety Practices

(b) A program must develop and implement a system of management, including ongoing training, oversight, correction and continuous improvement in accordance with §1302.102, that includes policies and practices to ensure all facilities, equipment and materials, background checks, safety training, safety and hygiene practices and administrative safety procedures are adequate to ensure child safety.

§ 1302.74(a) Safety Procedures

(a) A program must ensure children who receive transportation services are taught safe riding practices, safety procedures for boarding and leaving the vehicle and for crossing the street to and from the vehicle at stops, recognition of the danger zones around the vehicle, and emergency evacuation procedures, including participating in an emergency evacuation drill conducted on the vehicle the child will be riding.

Policy

PPS Early Learners incorporates a system of health and safety practices that ensures a safe, secure and healthy environment to support children's learning and development.

Procedure

- Health and Safety Checks (Facilities, equipment, materials safety)
- Personnel Policies (background checks)
- Safety Training for all staff (direct service and non-direct service)
- Active Supervision
- Hygiene practices (handwashing)
- Hygiene practices (diapering)
- Dismissal to Authorized Adult (see below)
- Late Pick Up (see below)
- Sick Child
- Medication Administration
- Food Allergies in the Classroom
- Emergencies/Disaster Preparedness and School Emergency Response Plans (SERP)
- Incident Reporting
- Transportation procedure (where do we state that we provide the STOPPS training for all the kids?)

Child Arrival and Departure

Procedure

Children can be signed in to the classroom by anyone who is dropping them off to school for the day. At departure, only individuals listed on the child's Emergency Contact form (ChildPlus Report 1520) will be allowed to sign the child out. In general, siblings age 12 and older may be allowed to sign out the Head Start child. This must be pre-approved by the Early Learners Administrator and/or Family Engagement Manager in consultation with parents and education staff.

If the sibling is younger than 12, parents/guardians will complete the "Parent Request for Minor Sibling Pick Up" pick up form. This form includes justification, how the child will get home, back up plan, and dates approved, and signatures from family, Family Engagement Manager, and Early Learning Administrator. (Form includes a check box for notification to Family Advocate and Administrative Assistant.)

When a parent/guardian requests to add or delete approved people to pick up their child from school, please:

1. Refer parent/guardian to Family Advocate
2. Family Advocates will update the information in ChildPlus and print a new Emergency Contact Form for the classroom.
3. A Change of Status form will be completed by Family Advocates so Synergy records can be updated.
4. All staff releasing children to approved pick-up list individuals will check identification if they are not familiar with that person.
5. Emergency Contact Form information will be reviewed and updated at the teacher's first home visit.

Late Pick Up:

- When a child is not picked up at the end of the school day, the child will remain in their classroom for the first 7.5 minutes with Teacher then they will be taken to the designated space at the site (example: Family Advocate office). Teachers and Family Advocate will reach out to caregivers and emergency contacts, as listed on the Emergency Contact form, until someone is on their way to pick up the child.
- Teacher will sign the child in (transfer supervision) to designated space and confirm accepting staff acknowledge the child. Teachers will make a name tag for children as needed for safety.
- No staff should be left alone with more than 5 children whenever possible.
- All sites will maintain a master Emergency Contact binder so that the Family Advocate staff, or any other staff supporting late pick ups, is able to verify identification for adults picking children up. Each master binder will include a blank sign in/sign out sheet for teachers and caregivers to complete.
- If a child is still not picked up 60 minutes after the end of the school day staff will notify Early Learning Administrator and/or Program Manager-Family Engagement for next steps.

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